



Tally — Manual

Track the drinks you buy for a party, and who pays what.

This manual walks you through everything step by step. No prior knowledge needed.

DE Deutsche Fassung: siehe Tally-Anleitung-DE.pdf

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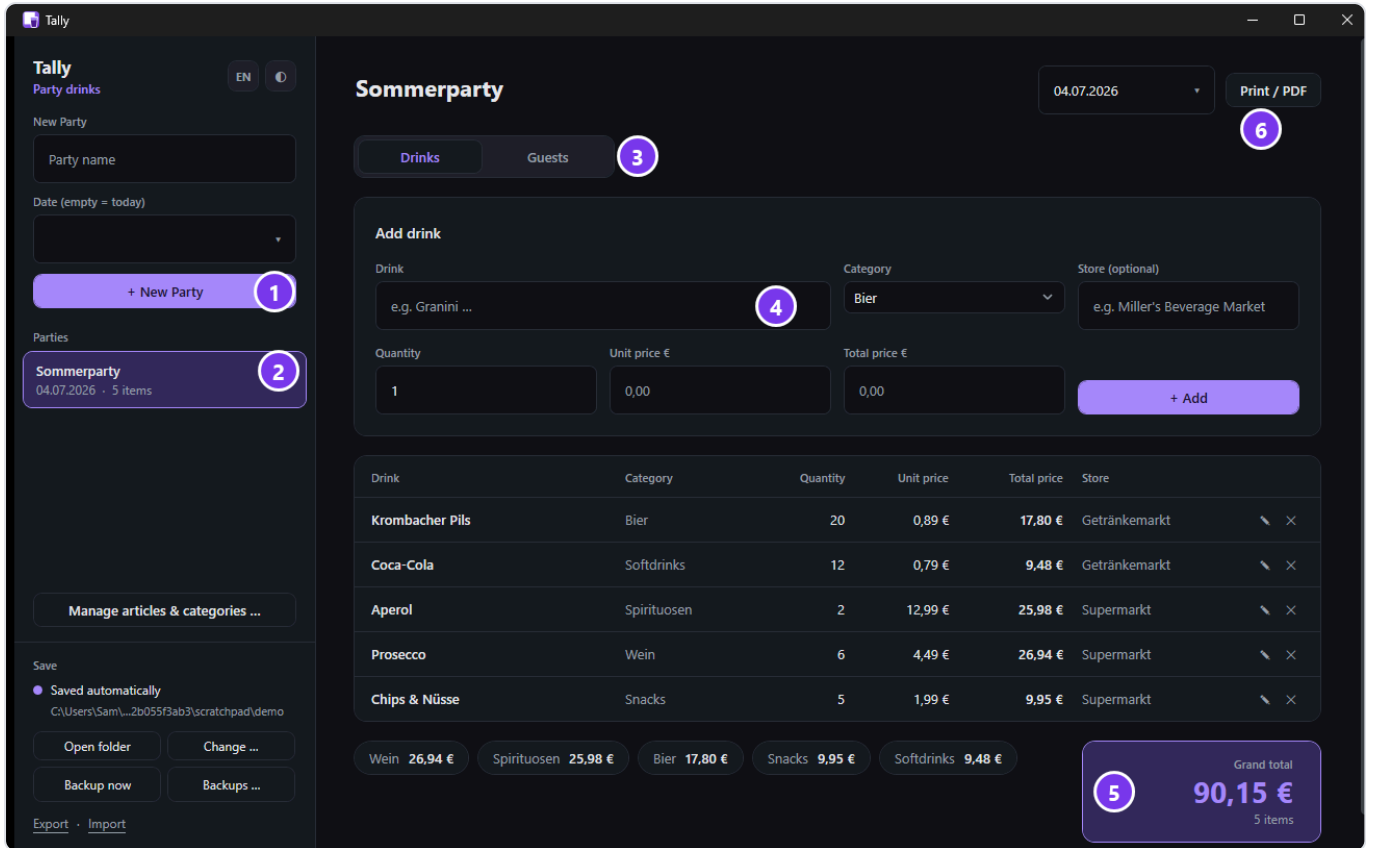
1. Starting the program

You only need **one single file**: `Tally.exe`. Double-click it — done. Nothing has to be installed.

On the first start Windows may say "Windows protected your PC". That's expected. Click **More info** → **Run anyway**. The message only appears once.

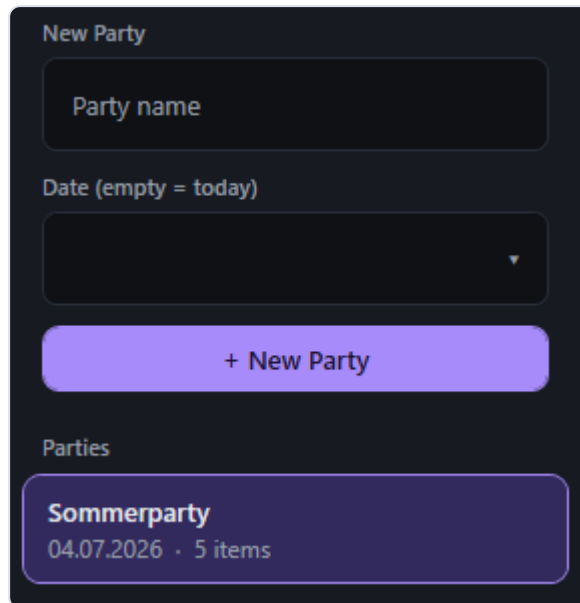
2. The overview

This is the window. The six places you need:



	What is it?
1	Create a new party here
2	Your parties . Click one to open it
3	Switch between Drinks and Guests
4	Enter a drink here
5	The grand total — what you have spent
6	Print , or save as PDF

3. Creating a party



New Party

Party name

Date (empty = today)

+ New Party

Parties

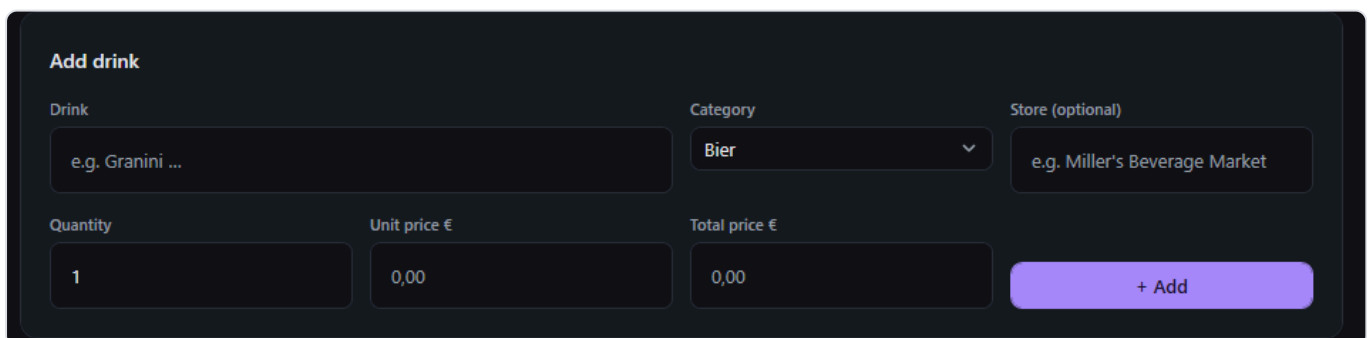
Sommerparty
04.07.2026 · 5 items

1. Type a **name** at the top, for example Summer party .
2. Pick a **date** below it. Leave it empty and the program uses today.
3. Click + **New Party**.

The party now appears in the list underneath. You can create as many parties as you like and switch between them at any time.

Tip: You can rename a party later — just click its title at the top of the window and start typing.

4. Entering drinks



Add drink

Drink

e.g. Granini ...

Category

Bier

Store (optional)

e.g. Miller's Beverage Market

Quantity

1

Unit price €

0,00

Total price €

0,00

+ Add

For every drink you bought:

1. **Drink** — the name, for example Krombacher Pils . As you type, the program suggests matching drinks. Press **Enter** to accept a suggestion.
2. **Category** — for example beer, wine, soft drinks. Pick one from the list.
3. **Store** — optional, for example Supermarket .
4. **Quantity** — how many bottles or crates.

5. **Unit price** — what *one* of them costs. The **total price** is worked out for you.

6. Click + **Add**.

Only know the total, say from the receipt? Then enter **quantity** and **total price** — the unit price is calculated automatically.

All drinks then appear in the list:

Drink	Category	Quantity	Unit price	Total price	Store	
Krombacher Pils	Bier	20	0,89 €	17,80 €	Getränkemarkt	 
Coca-Cola	Softdrinks	12	0,79 €	9,48 €	Getränkemarkt	 
Aperol	Spirituosen	2	12,99 €	25,98 €	Supermarkt	 
Prosecco	Wein	6	4,49 €	26,94 €	Supermarkt	 
Chips & Nüsse	Snacks	5	1,99 €	9,95 €	Supermarkt	 

Wein 26,94 €

Spirituosen 25,98 €

Bier 17,80 €

Snacks 9,95 €

Softdrinks 9,48 €

Grand total

- The **pencil**  edits a row.
- The **cross**  deletes it.

At the bottom you see what you have spent in total, and per category:

Wein 26,94 €	Spirituosen 25,98 €	Bier 17,80 €	Snacks 9,95 €	Softdrinks 9,48 €	Grand total 90,15 € 5 items
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5. Guests: who pays what

Click **Guests** at the top.

Add guest

Guest

Amount €

+ Add

Guest	Amount	Paid	Open	
Lisa	18,00	18,00	0,00 €	✓ ✕
Tom	18,00	10,00	8,00 €	✓ ✕
Anna	18,00	18,00	0,00 €	✓ ✕
Max	18,00	0,00	18,00 €	✓ ✕

Adding a guest:

1. Enter a **name**, for example `Lisa` .
2. Enter an **amount** — what this guest should pay.
3. Click + **Add**.

When someone pays:

Just type the amount into the **Paid** column. The **Open** column updates itself instantly.

- Has someone paid **in full**? Click the **tick** ✓ — that fills in the whole amount.
- Someone paid only part of it? Type the part, for example `10,00` . Tom above still has `8,00 €` outstanding.
- The **cross** ✕ deletes a guest. You'll be asked first.

Important: The amounts are always **yours** to decide. The program never splits anything on its own and never changes a number you typed.

6. The result

At the bottom of the Guests page you see how the party stands financially:

Spent **90,15 €**

Collected **46,00 €**

Still open **26,00 €**

Result

-44,15 €

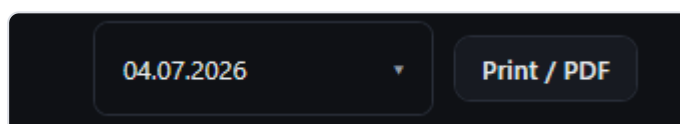
Collected - spent

Purchase not covered yet

	Meaning
Spent	What the drinks cost you
Collected	What your guests have actually paid you
Still open	What you are still owed
Result	Collected – spent

At the start the result is red and negative — that is **completely normal**. You paid for the drinks before anyone gave you money. The more guests pay, the higher the number climbs. Once it turns green, the party has paid for itself.

7. Printing or saving as PDF



The button in the top right prints **whatever you are looking at**:

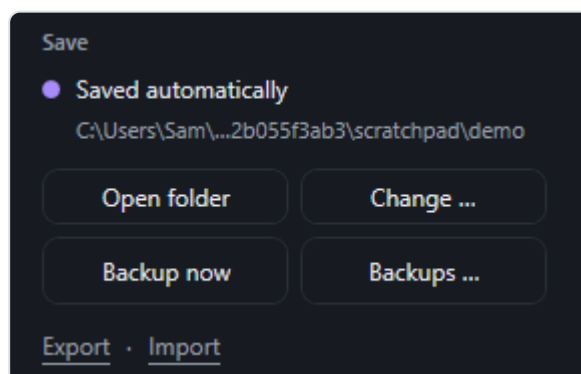
- On the **Drinks** tab → it prints the **drinks invoice**.
- On the **Guests** tab → it prints the **guest list**.

So you get two separate sheets — handy if you want to pass the guest list around.

Saving as PDF: In the print dialog, choose the printer "**Microsoft Print to PDF**". That produces a PDF file instead of paper.

You can also press **Ctrl + P**.

8. Saving and backups



You never have to click Save. Every change is saved automatically after about a second. The dot on the left tells you everything is stored.

The buttons below:

Button	What it does
Open folder	Shows your files in Explorer
Change ...	Picks a different storage location, e.g. a USB stick or OneDrive
Backup now	Makes a backup immediately
Backups ...	Shows all earlier versions — you can restore any of them
Export	Saves everything into one file, to pass on
Import	Loads such a file back in

Backups are made **automatically**: on startup, every 10 minutes and on exit. When you restore something, your current state is backed up first — so you cannot lose anything.

Where is my data?

What	Where
Your data	Documents\Tally\tally.json
Backups	Documents\Tally\Backups\

Everything stays on your own PC. Nothing is uploaded anywhere.

9. Language and theme



Top left, next to the name:

- DE / EN switches between **German** and **English**.
- The **circle** ● switches between **light** and **dark theme**.

You can change both at any time. The program remembers your choice.

10. Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Effect
Enter in the drink field	Accepts the suggestion and jumps to quantity
Enter in the other fields	Saves the entry
↑ / ↓	Picks a suggestion
Tab	Accepts the suggestion
Esc	Closes the suggestion list, or cancels editing
Ctrl + P	Print

11. Frequently asked questions

Do I have to save? No. It happens automatically.

Can I put the program on a USB stick? Yes. Just copy `Tally.exe` onto it. With **Change ...** you can put your data on the stick too.

I deleted something by accident. Click **Backups ...** and restore an earlier version. Your current state is backed up first.

Can I run several parties at once? Yes, as many as you like. Each has its own drinks and guests.

Why is the result red? Because so far you have spent more than you have taken in. That is always the case at the start. See [The result](#).

Does the program work out the amounts for my guests? No, you do that deliberately yourself. That way you stay free to decide — for example that someone pays less because they only drank water.

The prices use a comma instead of a point. That's on purpose: amounts are always shown in German format (12,50 €), even with the interface in English. When typing you may use either — `12,50` and `12.50` both work.

The categories are in German. The built-in list of drinks and categories ships in German, because that's where the app comes from. You can rename them, delete them or add your own under **Manage articles & categories**